I didn't, but it was long enough. When I emerged, there were loud outcries and the sergeant seized me roughly by the arm and shouted. "Here he is!"

I thought: Now what have I done?

I hadn't done anything. The various interviewers had just come across my AGCT score and were arguing as to who could have the fun of interviewing me. It turned out that my score was 160, and none of them had ever seen a score that high. When they settled the argument among themselves, I was interviewed with something approaching awe.

Naturally, I was very pleased and in an attack of naivete" thought this might make my Army life easier for me, perhaps even spare me basic training. My interviewer told me, unofficially, I would probably be assigned to Camp Lee, Virginia, and he somehow made it sound as though it was an intellectual's haven—the Army equivalent of an Ivy League college.

That was exactly where the glory of the 160 ended. After we were through with the interview, everyone had to shoulder his duffel bag and trot over to another area. Everyone trotted. No one seemed to be aware that he was carrying fifty pounds. No one except me. I lagged far behind, puffing, sweating, and strangling, and no one seemed to think a head full of 160 should be spared the necessity of carrying fifty pounds. No one even noticed me except a sergeant who barked, "Get a move on, soldier."

In the evening, I got my first menial detail. I was sent to the officers' club and told to empty ashtrays and trashcans and to do some general sweeping. Such officers as were present bent vacant eyes upon me now and then. They apparently couldn't see the 160 written on my forehead.

My illusions didn't last. I was a private in the Army and nothing else counted. I was the scum of the earth.

5

On the night of November 5, I managed to find a telephone and I tried to call Gertrude. She was at the Henry Paper Box Company, of

course, though Henry himself was not. I told him about the results of the test and asked him to pass it on to Gertrude.

Later on, Gertrude told a friend who had let her know her boyfriend's or husband's score—which was well above the 100 average, but not remarkably